

ChristosHadjinikolis

Staff/Director-Level ML Tech Lead | Ph.D.

Committee Expert Member @ JTC'21

✉ christos.hadjinikolis@gmail.com

mediums

🌐 personal website

 LinkedIn

 github

 Google Scholar

 YouTube

languages

bilingual Greek/English

programming

Python, Java, Kotlin (Kafka Streams), SQL, Cypher

author

pypi:dynamicio

leadership scope

ML roadmap, delivery leadership, technical guidance, supervision, team scaling, stakeholder management, hiring/interviewing, mentorship, AI governance, auditability

cloud-platforms

AWS, GCP

technologies & frameworks

MLOps, MCP, agent harnesses, Transformers, PyTorch-distributed, Kafka, Kafka Streams, py/Flink, FastApi, Docker, MLflow, Kubeflow, Airflow, AWS CodeArtifact, Elasticsearch

interests

Sports: Tennis, Jogging,

Reading: Comics, Philosophy, Politics

about me

Staff-level ML Tech Lead operating at Staff/Director scope, with 15+ years across AI research, production ML systems, MLOps, and developer-facing platform work. Lead initiatives spanning roadmap shaping, prioritisation, stakeholder alignment, architecture standards, mentoring, and real-time inference/event-driven systems. Strong record of scaling R&D impact across systems, people, and product quality by raising engineering standards through CI/CD, schema discipline, lineage, auditability, observability, and pragmatic AI governance.

work-experience

since 12/2020 **Vortexa Ltd, London, UK**

ML Tech Lead (Staff-Level) | Pod Lead

Lead ML-driven product capabilities for maritime forecasting, combining transformer-based modelling, AI signal cleaning, destination routing, real-time inference, event-driven architecture, back-end services, and production rollout discipline. Influence engineering practices across a 70-person R&D department through technical supervision, product ownership, stakeholder management, backlog prioritisation, mentoring, and standardisation.

- **AI Product Delivery:** Led destination, routing, signal-cleaning, and waiting-time model services, translating R&D into production capabilities with measurable latency, throughput, and prediction-quality gains.
- **Event-Driven ML Platform:** Drove **Flink**, **Kafka**, and **Kotlin/Kafka Streams** adoption; improved throughput by 25%, reduced batch bottlenecks, and future-proofed pipelines against company strategy.
- **R&D Scalability:** Raised ML maturity across teams through CI/CD, model/data versioning, schema management, data lineage, auditability, end-to-end tests, ADRs, architecture forums, and repeatable releases.
- **Leadership & Mentorship:** Managed a remote pod, onboarded and mentored engineers, supported hiring/interviewing, and ran an event-driven architecture mentoring programme.
- **Platform Reuse & Governance:** Created **Dynamicio**, adopted across 15+ repositories; implemented **AWS CodeArtifact** adoption for safer internal package publication, reuse, and team-level scalability.
- **AI Developer Tooling:** Identified **LLM/vibe-coding review friction** and initiated MCP/harness work for status lookup, alerting, failure tracking, and audit evidence.
- **Roadmap Balance:** Balanced product delivery, technical-debt reduction, regulatory controls, and stakeholder priorities within a shared ML roadmap.

2016–2020 **DataReply, London, UK**

Data Scientist | ML Engineer

Progressed from Data Scientist to ML Engineer, leading cross-functional DS/DE delivery across UBS, Vodafone, and CNHi. Focused on ML platformisation, workflow automation, observability, deployment governance, and maintainable enterprise systems.

- **Vodafone Group (09/2019–11/2020, London):**
 - Co-led Vodafone's internal MLOps platform (**Infinity Project**) on GCP using **Kubeflow**, supporting model versioning, deployment, telemetry, experiment workflows, and resource-governed notebooks.
 - Implemented CI/CD, shared feature/data workflows, and monitoring for reproducible production ML.
- **CNHi (05/2019–09/2019, Chicago):**
 - Built **time-series forecasting** models and transitioned statistical prototypes into scalable cloud services for operational alerting.
- **UBS (08/2017–04/2019, London):**
 - Designed real-time **graph analytics** and **process mining** pipelines for organisational insights and decision automation.
 - Developed observability tooling with **Kafka**, **Elasticsearch**, and Python.

2010–2016 **Roles in UK Institutions**

Assoc. Lect. @GSM | Coding Teacher @DGC | TA @KCL|UCL

Taught computing during doctoral studies, building deep technical communication habits and the ability to make complex computer science and AI ideas operational for others.

- **2012–2016:** Lectured in Computing, MATLAB, Java, Python, HTML, CSS at GSM and David Game College
- **2010–2014:** TA at King's College London (KCL) and UCL, covering Java, Data Structures, Systems Architecture, Semantic Web, SQL, and AI.

education

- 2010–2014 **Ph.D. in Computer Science** [King's College London, UK](#)
Thesis: Persuasion Dialogues & Opponent Modelling.
Developed logical inference methods for large **Knowledge Graphs**, combining symbolic reasoning, **graph analytics**, and Bayesian techniques (e.g., MCMC). Research contributed to scalable AI systems grounded in formal semantics. Received **Best Poster Award** at IJCAI 2013 (413 submissions). Awarded **EPSRC PhD Scholarship**, **Outstanding TA Award** (student-nominated), and earned the **Graduate Certificate in Academic Practice**.
[Access Publications on Google Scholar](#)
- 2004–2010 **Diploma (BEng) in Computer Engineering** [University of Thessaly, GR](#)
Five-year polytechnic degree in Computer Science and Engineering with a **strong focus on mathematics** (10 courses), covering theoretical aspects, networking, and telecommunications. *Majored in Artificial Intelligence.*
- 2002–2004 **Military Officer: Second Lieutenant** [National Guard, CY](#)
Obligatory army service; position acquired through **competitive IQ** and athletic exams.

committees/affiliations

- since 10/2024 **University College London, Dept. of Information Studies** [Associate Researcher](#)
Support AI application, standardisation, and ethics initiatives in industry and academia.
- since 01/2021 **ISO - International Organisation for Standardisation** [Committee Expert Member for JTC'21](#)
Member of JTC'21 Working Group 3, developing AI standards aligned with EU policies and international norms.

talks/interviews

- 2023 **Bill Raymonds, Agile in Action** [Podcast Interview](#)
Agile Data Science: Sailing Through Data Science: The Agile Journey at Vortexa, [Details: YouTube](#)
- 2022 **Open Data Science Conference** [Industry Conference Talk](#)
Dynamicio, a python library for abstracting your I/O, [Details: here](#)
- 2020 **iunera: Big Data Innovators** [Interview Blog Post](#)
The Agile approach in data science explained by an ML expert, [Details: here](#)
- 2020 **Big Data Warsaw** [Industry Conference Talk](#)
Monitoring and Analysing Communication and Trade Events as Graphs, [Details: here](#)
- 2018 **Connected Data London** [Panelist @ Industry Conference](#)
AI tribes and interconnections: what's graph got to do with it?, [Details: here](#)
- 2018 **Minds Mastering Machines** [Industry Conference Talk](#)
A talk on doing Data Science the Agile Way, [Details: here](#)

certificates & awards

- 07/2020 **AWS Certified Machine Learning - Specialty** [AWS](#)
Validation Number: D0R0WC7CN1VQ13SV
- 01/2019 **Process Mining** [Coursera Course Certificates](#)
License number: AFU2VTP6273V
- 10/2017 **Google Certified Professional - Data Engineer** [Google Cloud Certified](#)
Credential ID: 000000400
- 07/2017 **Advanced Elasticsearch: Data modelling** [Elastic](#)
Enrolment Id: 33442
- 06/2016 **Graph Analytics for Big Data** [Coursera Course Certificates](#)
License number: NZADYAQ7N8FW
- 05/2016 **Apache Spark Developer Certification** [O'Reilly Media](#)
License number: 1.x-0548
- 04/2016 **Neo4j Certified Professional** [Neo Technology, Creators of Neo4j](#)
License number: here